

Package leaflet: Information for the patient (PIL)

— Local English (Synthetic / Mock)

Cardiomel 20 mg / 40 mg film-coated tablets

nefrosartan

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Read all of this leaflet carefully before you start taking this medicine because it contains important information for you.

- Keep this leaflet. You may need to read it again.
- If you have any further questions, ask your doctor or pharmacist.
- This medicine has been prescribed for you only. Do not pass it on to others.
- If you get any side effects, talk to your doctor or pharmacist. This includes any possible side effects not listed in this leaflet.

1. What Cardiomel is and what it is used for

Cardiomel contains **nefrosartan**, which helps lower high blood pressure. It is used to treat **high blood pressure (hypertension)** in adults.

2. What you need to know before you take Cardiomel

Do not take Cardiomel if:

- you are allergic to nefrosartan or any of the other ingredients of this medicine
- you are **more than 3 months pregnant** (it is also better to avoid Cardiomel in early pregnancy)
- you have **severe liver problems**
- you have diabetes or kidney problems and are taking a medicine containing **aliskiren**

Warnings and precautions

Talk to your doctor or pharmacist before taking Cardiomel if you: - have kidney problems, kidney artery narrowing, or are on dialysis - have liver problems - are dehydrated (vomiting/diarrhoea) or take water tablets (diuretics) - are taking medicines that can increase potassium - have had swelling of the face/lips/tongue (angioedema) before

Other medicines and Cardiomel

Tell your doctor or pharmacist if you are taking: - potassium supplements, salt substitutes, or potassium-sparing diuretics

- anti-inflammatory painkillers (NSAIDs, e.g. ibuprofen)
- lithium (for mood disorders)
- other blood pressure medicines

Pregnancy and breast-feeding

- Do not take Cardiomel if you are more than 3 months pregnant.
- Tell your doctor if you are pregnant or think you may be pregnant.
- Breast-feeding is not recommended while taking Cardiomel.

Driving and using machines

Cardiomel can make some people feel dizzy or tired. If this happens, do not drive or use machines.

Cardiomel contains lactose

Cardiomel contains lactose. If you have been told by your doctor that you have an intolerance to some sugars, contact your doctor before taking this medicine.

3. How to take Cardiomel

Always take this medicine exactly as your doctor has told you.

- The usual starting dose is **40 mg once a day**.
- Your doctor may increase your dose.
- Some people may be prescribed up to **160 mg a day**.

Take the tablet with a glass of water, with or without food. Try to take it at the same time each day.

If you take more Cardiomel than you should

Contact a doctor or go to a hospital straight away. You may feel dizzy or faint due to low blood pressure.

If you forget to take Cardiomel

Take it as soon as you remember on the same day. Do not take a double dose to make up for a forgotten tablet.

If you stop taking Cardiomel

Do not stop without speaking to your doctor.

4. Possible side effects

Like all medicines, this medicine can cause side effects, although not everybody gets them.

Stop taking Cardiomel and get urgent medical help if you get:

- swelling of the face, lips, tongue or throat, difficulty breathing (may be a sign of angioedema)

Common side effects (may affect up to 1 in 10 people)

- dizziness, headache
- feeling tired
- low blood pressure (especially when standing up)
- feeling sick, diarrhoea
- blood test changes: potassium may increase; kidney function tests may change

Uncommon side effects

- rash or itching
- palpitations

Reporting side effects

If you get any side effects, talk to your doctor or pharmacist. You can also report side effects via your national reporting system. By reporting side effects you can help provide more information on the safety of this medicine.

5. How to store Cardiomel

- Keep this medicine out of the sight and reach of children.
- Do not use this medicine after the expiry date.
- Store below 30°C. Keep in the original package to protect from moisture.

6. Contents of the pack and other information

What Cardiomel contains

- The active substance is nefrosartan: 20 mg or 40 mg per tablet.

- The other ingredients include lactose monohydrate, microcrystalline cellulose, croscarmellose sodium, magnesium stearate, and film-coating ingredients (synthetic).

What Cardiomel looks like and contents of the pack

Film-coated tablets in blister packs or bottles; pack sizes may vary (synthetic).